

Chapter 78_2 - Heartache

It wasn't until darkness fell and the bright moon hung high overhead that Ning Fuyi finally stopped and put away her Lovesickness¹, bid farewell to Liu Wenzhu, and headed alone to the Moon Viewing Terrace.

Tonight's moon lived up to the poetic name of the Moon Viewing Terrace, like a piece of white jade spilling moonlight as clear as washed water. Ning Fuyi climbed step by step to the mountaintop, seeing from afar a figure standing in the Moon Viewing Terrace.

Yellow robes fluttering, black hair soft and gentle.

Ning Fuyi closed her eyes, steeling her resolve. When she wanted to approach but hesitated, she reached into her sleeve and withdrew a round, smooth pill.

It was the poison-avoiding pill she had commissioned someone to refine after returning from the mountain base that day. She tilted her head back and swallowed it.

She wasn't afraid of what others might do to her, she just didn't want to lose consciousness and lose herself.

When her vision became clearer due to the pill, only then did she lift her legs and fly up, landing gracefully. The yellow-robed woman turned around - it was indeed Mo Qihuai.

"Young Sect Leader, you've come," Mo Qihuai smiled warmly. She was indeed a beautiful woman, even more so under the moonlight, but Ning Fuyi always seemed to see through her face to another countenance as pure as the moon.

Ning Fuyi, stop thinking about it. Chu Qingqiu has a cold heart and indifferent nature. Even if she treats you well, how could she develop romantic feelings? And your hoping she would stop this is nothing more than believing Jiuying's nonsense. She is, after all, Chu Qingqiu - the one who granted you a sword in your previous life. How could you fall in love with such a person?

Moreover, how could the moon in the sky and mud on the ground ever meet?

"Young Sect Leader?" Mo Qihuai's gentle voice rang out, pulling her from her thoughts. "The moon is above the willow tips² - this is the perfect auspicious time."

With that, she extended her delicate hand to take Ning Fuyi's arm, leading her down the mountain.

Ning Fuyi felt somewhat numb, letting herself be led. Her feet felt like they were stuck in mud, each step very difficult. Her head, which hadn't hurt for a long time, suddenly began to ache faintly.

When she saw the shadow of the wooden house, the pain intensified, as if silver water was being poured backwards into her skull. In an instant, she couldn't lift her head and nearly fell to her knees.

Mo Qihuai was frightened by this sight and hurriedly reached out to grab her, her voice losing its gentleness: "Young Sect Leader! Young Sect Leader! Someone, someone..."

Before her words ended, a figure flew out from the tree shadows and landed, pulling the person from her hands into an embrace, looking down and saying, "Ning Fuyi!"

Mo Qihuai was so frightened her face turned pale. After looking several times, she finally recognized who it was and breathed a sigh of relief: "Divine Venerable, she suddenly fell ill. I had no way..."

"It's alright, you may go first. Jiang Li." Chu Qingqiu called out, and Jiang Li emerged from the bushes wearing several grass leaves, immediately pulling Mo Qihuai away.

"Come, come, come, junior sister! It seems you're not needed today. Let's go catch up!"

Seeing the two had left, Chu Qingqiu finally tensed up, looking down at the woman nestled in her arms. The pain had obviously taken away her consciousness. Large drops of sweat flowed from her forehead, quickly soaking the thin silk gauze at Chu Qingqiu's chest.

"It's alright, you'll be fine," Chu Qingqiu murmured softly, reaching under her knees to carry her horizontally.

She staggered two steps, her heart emitting a sharp pain - whether from old injuries or from heartache, she didn't know.

"You'll be fine..." she kept murmuring to herself, her body transforming into flowing light as she burst through the door, then sealed it with immortal power.

Jiuying had already been led away by Jiang Li. At this moment, only the two of them were in the wooden house. Chu Qingqiu hurried all the way to the bedroom, doors opening before her and closing with the wind, covered with barriers.

She placed Ning Fuyi on the bed, reaching out to wipe the sweat from the woman's face. Her hand gently moved downward, touching the collar of the green robe she had made.

Now that no one knew, no one could see, she no longer pretended - no longer disguised the pain and love in her eyes that she could no longer contain.

She summoned immortal power and channeled it into Ning Fuyi's temples. This time she didn't seal her six senses³, only used the immortal power to suppress the pain. When Ning Fuyi's tightly furrowed brow relaxed somewhat, she suddenly released her power.

"Yiyi⁴... it hurts a lot, doesn't it?" She half-knelt by the bed, her fingertips tracing the woman's lustrous face, caressing the two tear moles⁵ that no longer existed.

The emotions that had been sealed in her heart finally broke through their restraints, surging through her mind. A teardrop rolled from her eye socket, falling onto Ning Fuyi's neck and flowing into the countless soft strands behind.

She didn't see Ning Fuyi's fingertips tremble slightly.

"I said I wouldn't let you hurt anymore, yet I've broken my word again," Chu Qingqiu said quietly. Ning Fuyi's scent wafted toward her, and she found herself momentarily unable to control herself, sliding her hand into Ning Fuyi's palm, intertwining their fingers.

The woman's features, her form, even the smooth palm lines in her hand - everything made her heart flutter at the touch. No matter how close the contact, it was difficult to resist the crazy longing.

Like divine flower petals being moistened by mortal dew, the woman who had always been cold and self-possessed was finally filled with desire.

She lowered her head, pressing her cheek against Ning Fuyi's palm, closing her eyes as if savoring the moment.

"Yiyi, whatever you want, I'll give it all to you."

Footnotes:

¹ **Lovesickness (相思)** - Likely the name of Ning Fuyi's weapon or a martial arts technique

² **Moon above the willow tips (月上柳梢)** - A poetic expression referring to an ideal romantic time, typically around dusk or evening

³ **Six senses (六识)** - In Buddhist philosophy, the six consciousnesses: sight, hearing, smell, taste, touch, and mental consciousness

⁴ **Yiyi (衣衣)** - An affectionate nickname for Ning Fuyi, derived from her name

⁵ **Tear moles (泪痣)** - Small moles positioned near the eyes, traditionally associated with a fate of crying or sadness in Chinese physiognomy